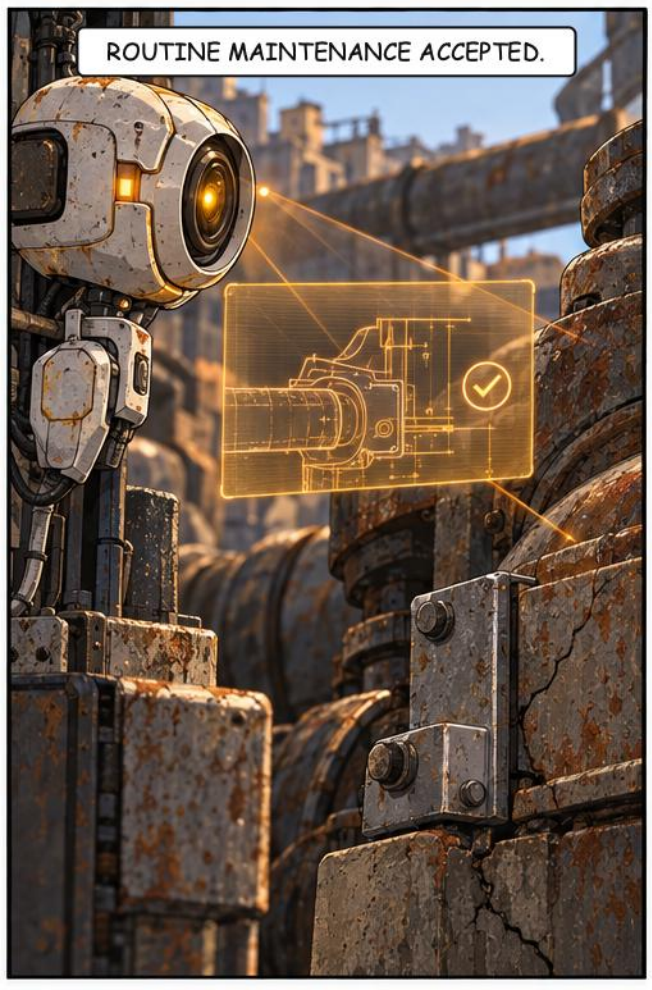
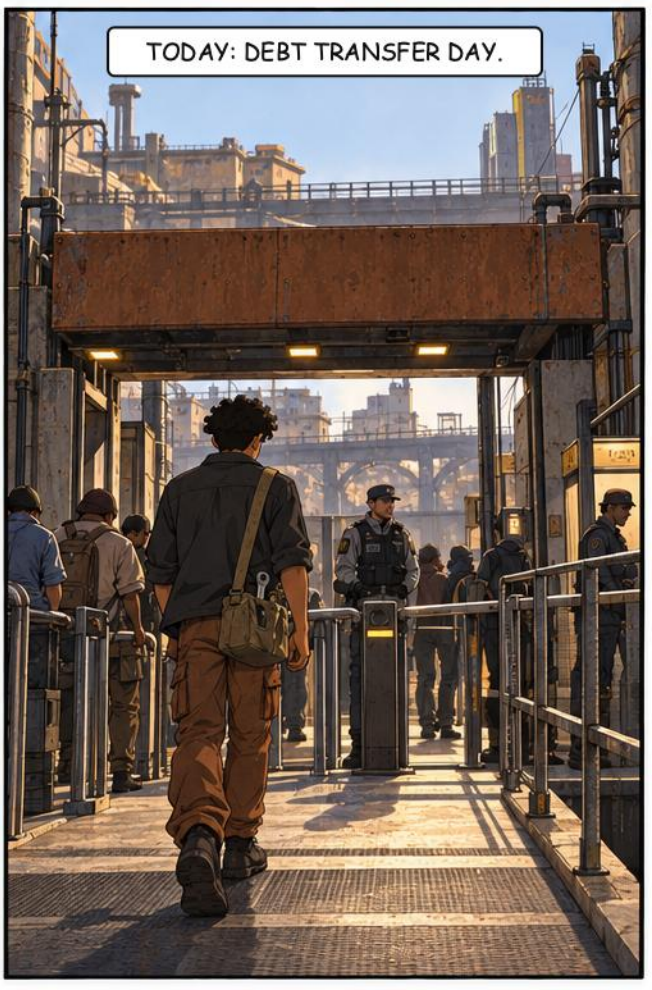



THRUM

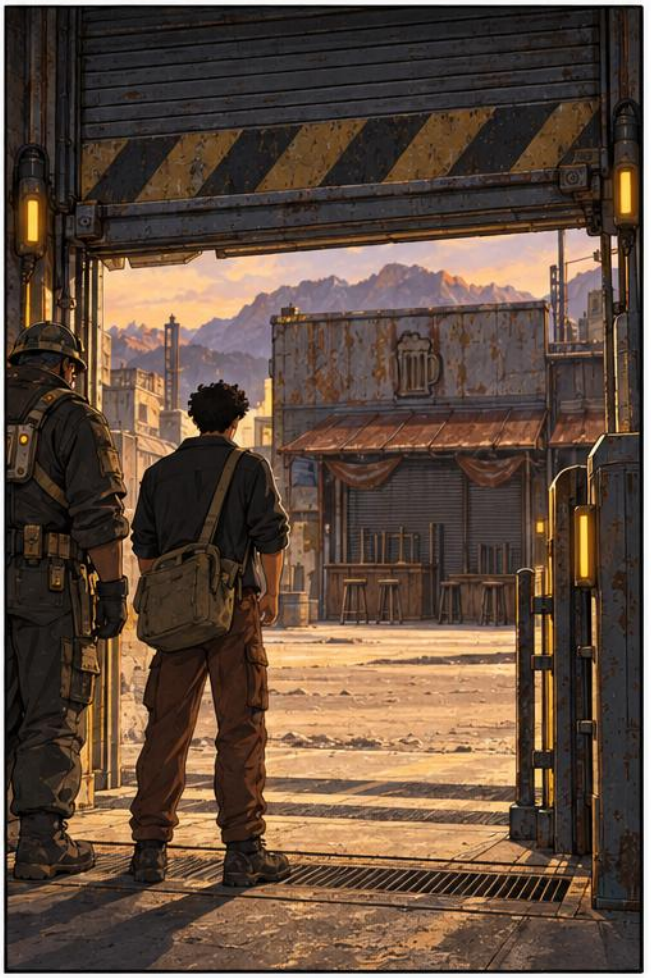

ROUTINE MAINTENANCE ACCEPTED.


TODAY: DEBT TRANSFER DAY.


AGE VERIFIED. SEVENTEEN.


PARENTAL HOUSEHOLD LIABILITY TRANSFER: COMPLETE ORIGINAL DEBTOR: ADRIAN PHANTUM — WHEREABOUTS UNRECORDED DEBT BALANCE: 418,607 CREDITS PROJECTED CLEARANCE: 28.7 YEARS

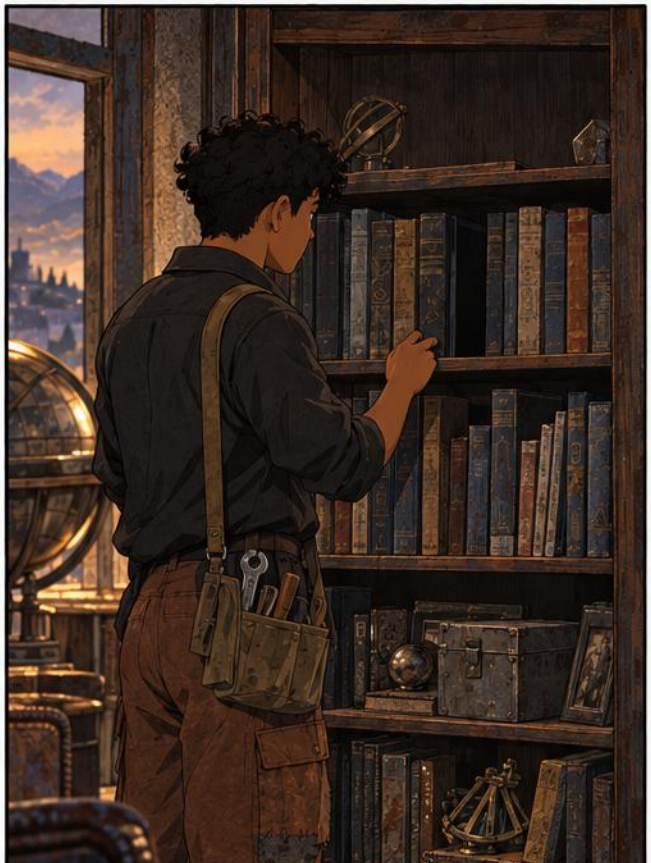

HAPPY BIRTHDAY, PHANTUM.
TWENTY-EIGHT POINT SEVEN.




I SAVED ENOUGH FOR ONE.
THERE ARE TWO MUGS.
I'M GENEROUS WITH CONTAINERS.
YOU'RE STILL LEAVING.
EVENTUALLY.
KEEL'S NOT A SENTENCE.
THE BALANCE DISAGREES.
I'M YOUR FRIEND, ALEX. NOT YOUR EXIT PLAN.


I WAS TWO.
YOU REMEMBER NOTHING?
THE WATCH.
KEEL SAYS HE GAMBLED.
GRANDMOTHER SAYS HE WORKED.
WHAT ARE YOU LOOKING FOR?
THE PART THAT COSTS.

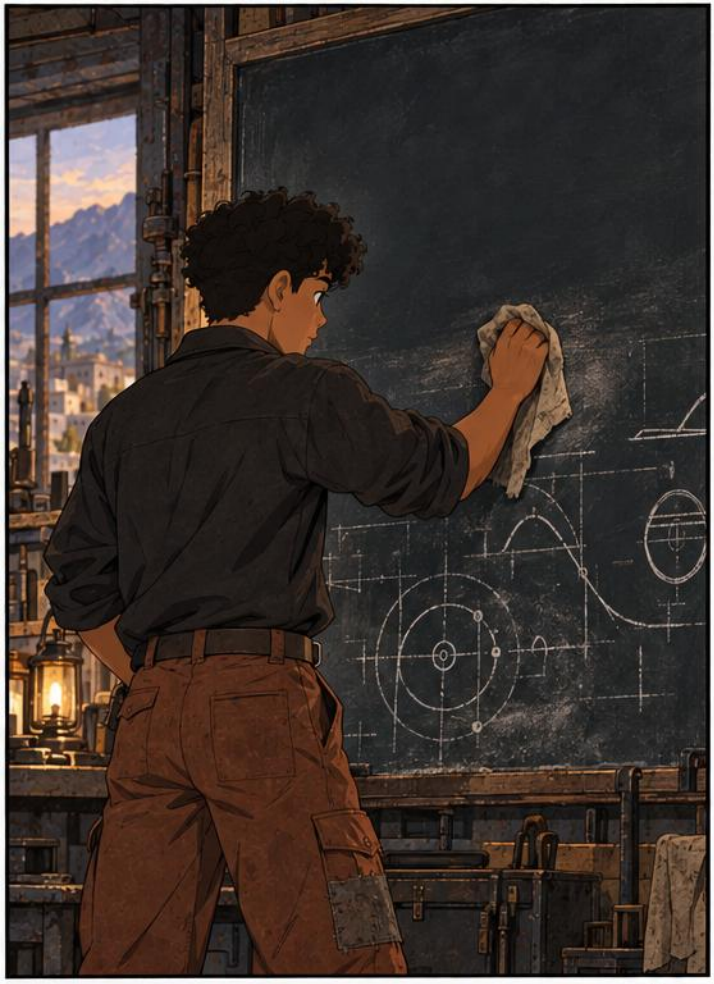

NEXT DOSE IN FOUR HOURS.
ALEX.
HE SAID YOU'D KNOW WHEN YOU WERE READY.





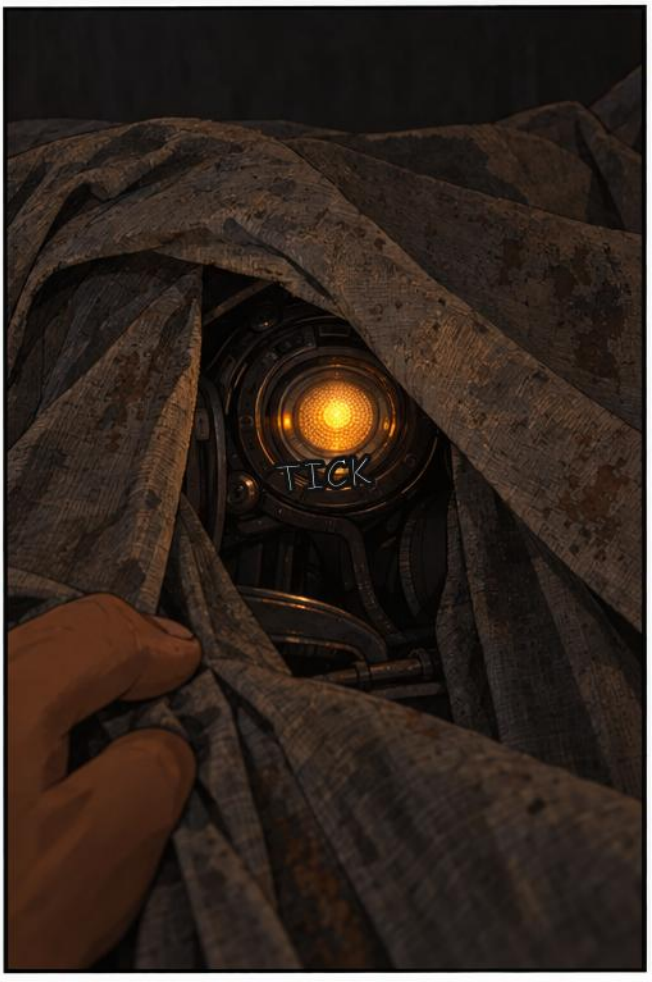

KLIK


THAT'S ONE WAY TO HIDE A ROOM.
BADLY, EVENTUALLY.






THIS PART'S OLD.
THE DUST ISN'T.


TICK

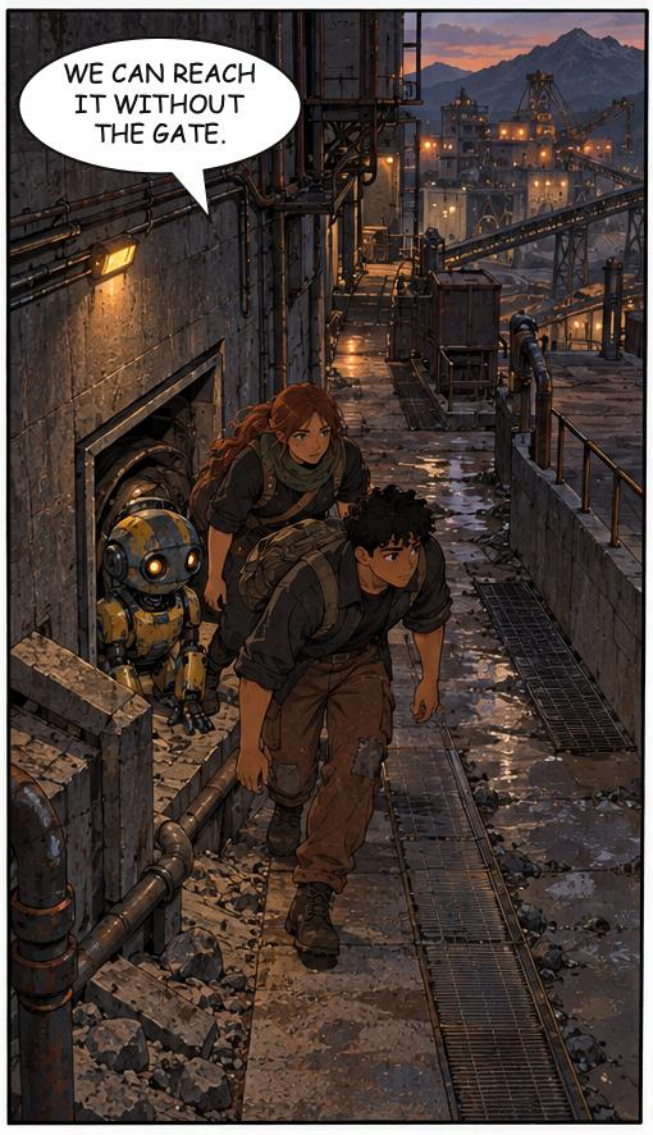

CHK
WELL. THAT TOOK LONGER THAN EXPECTED.
YOU KNOW ME?
ADRIAN'S JAW. HIS POORER TIMING.
BI11BOT. B11 IF THE ROOM IS ON FIRE.


ALEX. IF YOU'RE SEEING THIS, I FAILED TO COME BACK.
I BORROWED TOO MUCH. I GAMBLED SOME OF IT. I HURT YOU AND GRANDMOTHER.
THE WORK WAS SHARED. THE MISTAKES WERE MINE.
QUESTION EVERYTHING. ESPECIALLY ME.

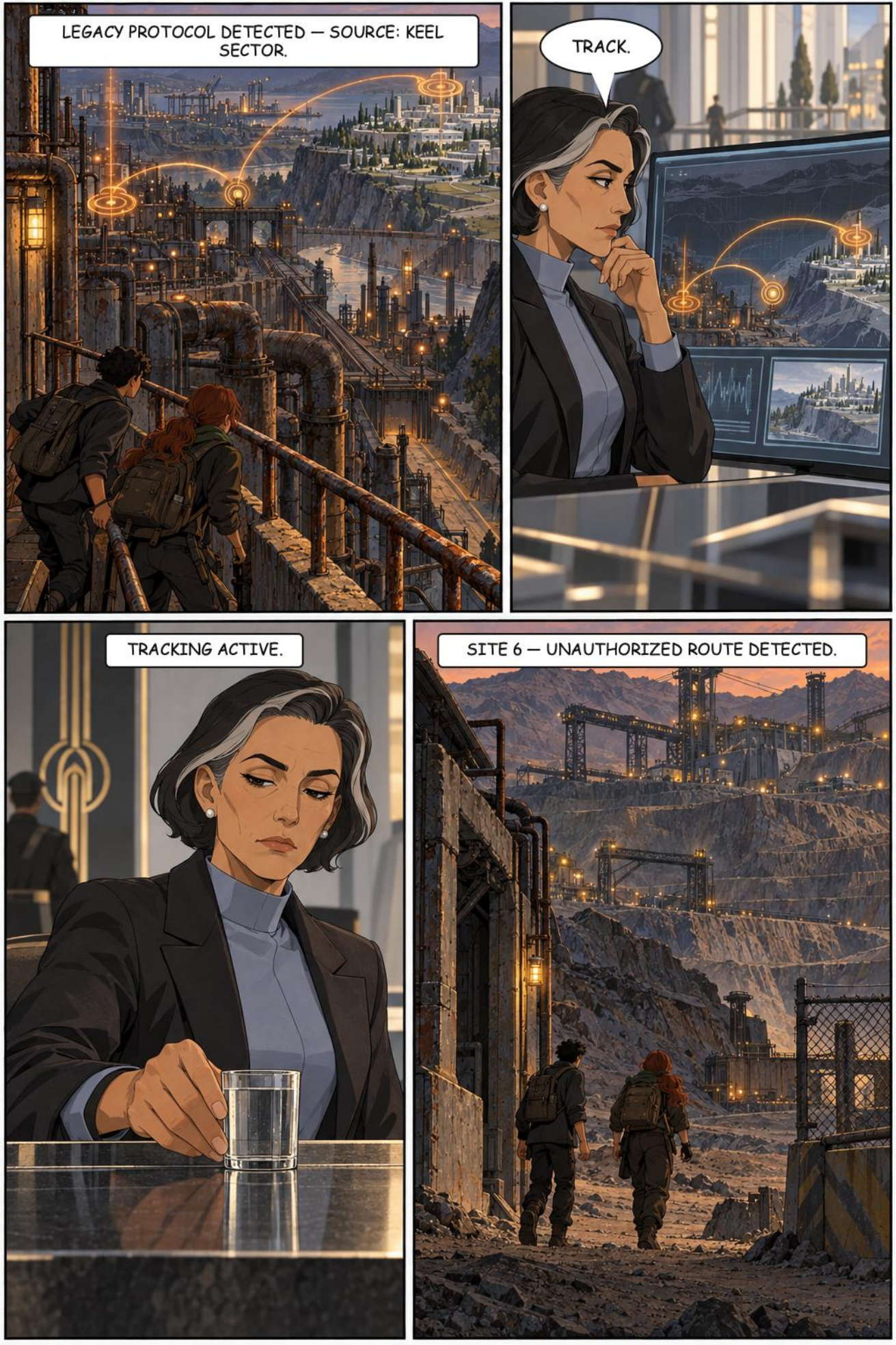

MOVEMENT AUTHORIZATION: TEMPORARILY SUSPENDED.
BECAUSE THE BAND STOPPED REPORTING?
ALPHA CONTROLS MOVEMENT, RECORDS AND INFRASTRUCTURE. THE WORKSHOP WOKE. ALPHA NOTICED.
B11
IT FORGOT THE OLD SERVICE ROUTE.




THE FIRST IS BELOW SITE 6.


WE CAN REACH IT WITHOUT THE GATE.

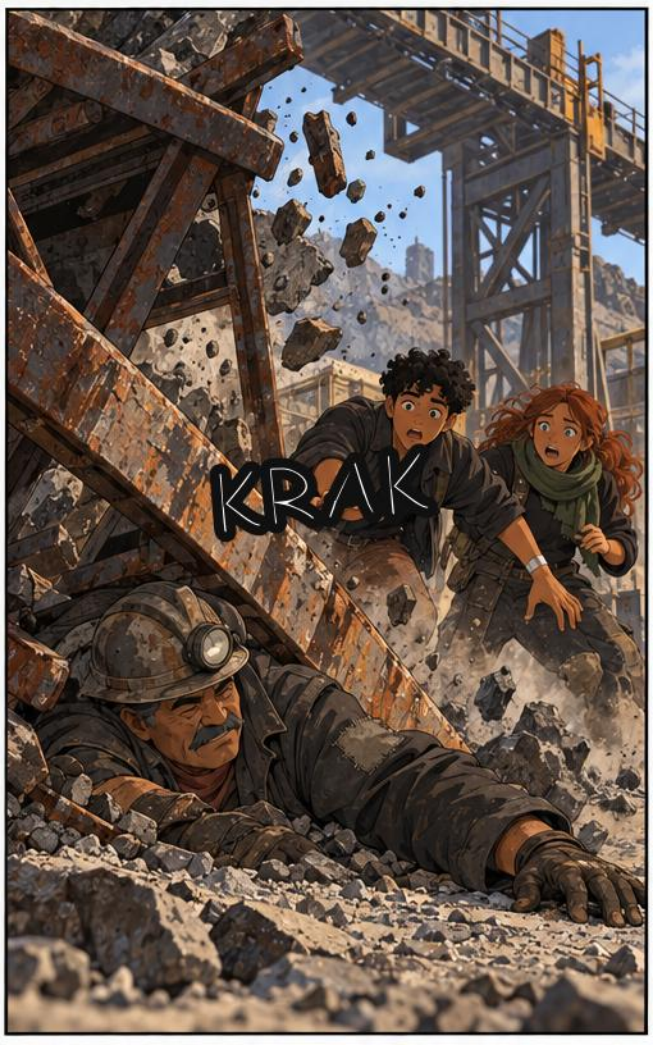

NO AUTHORITY.
THEN WE START HERE.


LEGACY PROTOCOL DETECTED — SOURCE: KEEL SECTOR.
TRACK.
TRACKING ACTIVE.
SITE 6 — UNAUTHORIZED ROUTE DETECTED.


FORTY CREDITS. KEY, TRAVEL TOKEN AND PARTS.
SEPARATE FROM THE HOUSEHOLD ACCOUNT?

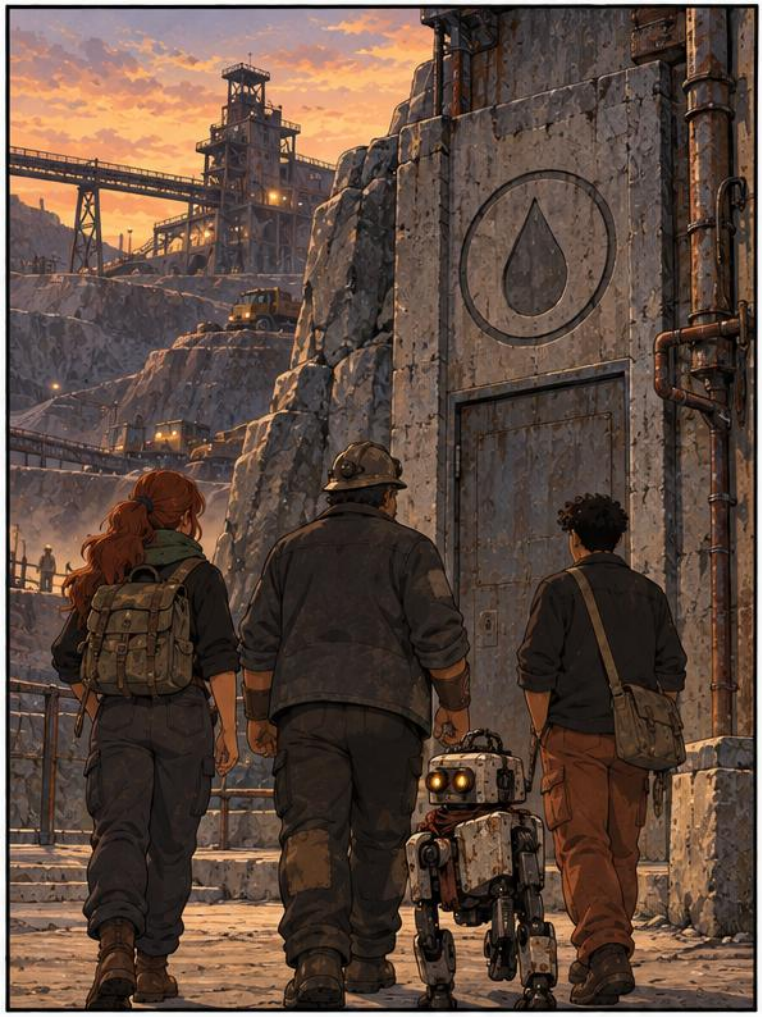

CURRENT INSTALLMENT: OVERDUE
TRAVEL: RESTRICTED AMOUNT
REQUIRED TO RESTORE: 500 CREDITS


PAY ME FROM HALYARD WORK.
I WILL.

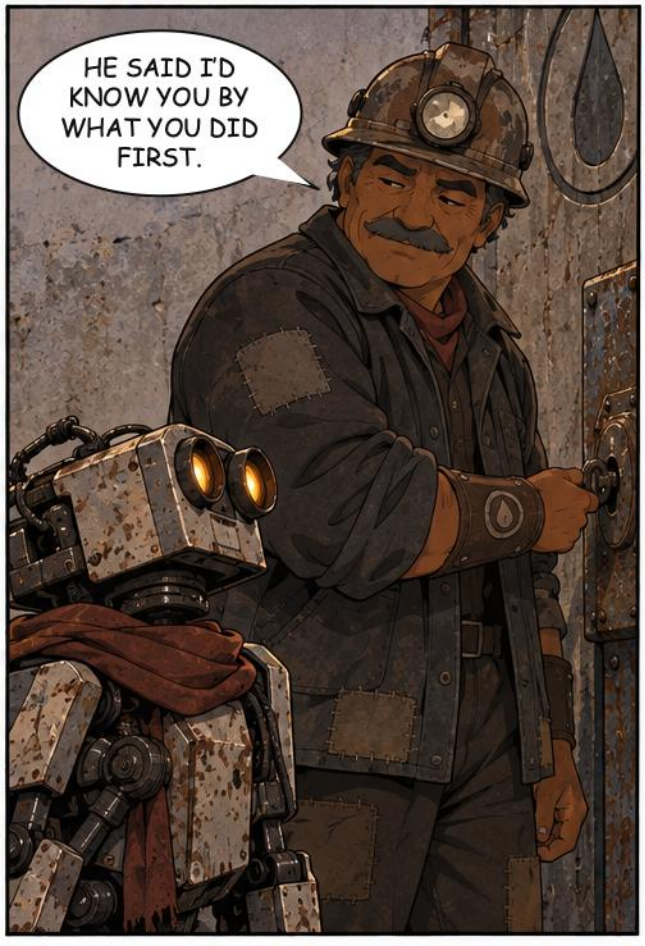

KRAK

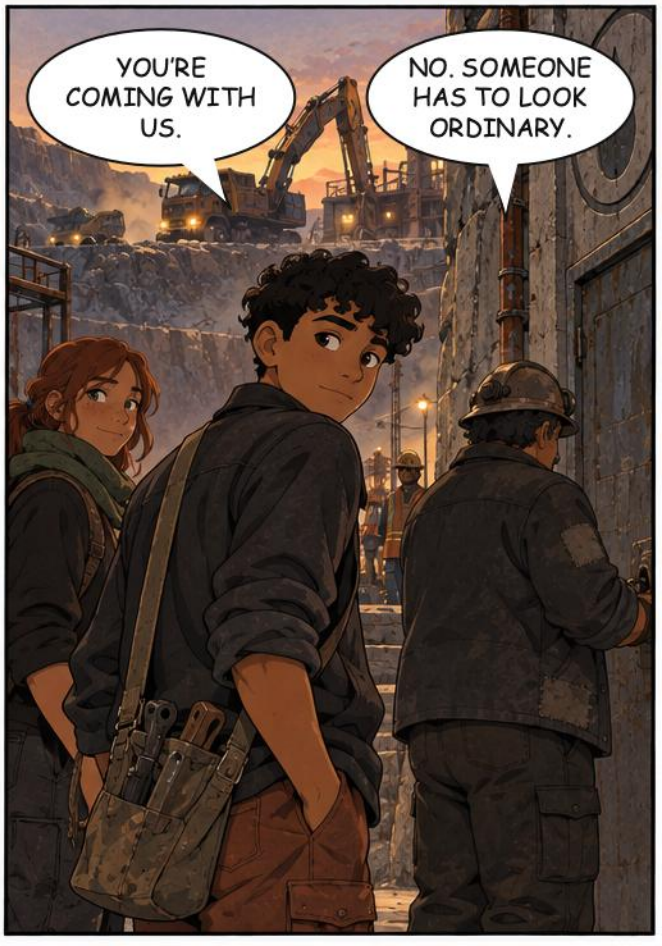

PHANTUM. RETURN TO YOUR ASSIGNED ZONE.
LEAVING ASSIGNED ZONE — WAGE FORFEITED: -40 CR.
YOU KNOW THAT COSTS YOU.
I NOTICED.
KRAK


MY ROUTE ASSUMED WE LEFT TOMAS WHERE HE FELL.
THAT WAS WRONG.
YES. WHAT WOULD YOU DO?
Bill
OBSTRUCTION OF AN AUTHORITY FUNCTION IS A HOUSEHOLD OFFENSE.
I'D USE THE DOOR THEY FORGOT.




ADRIAN ASKED ME TO KEEP THIS CLOSED.
FROM ME?


HE SAID I'D KNOW YOU BY WHAT YOU DID FIRST.

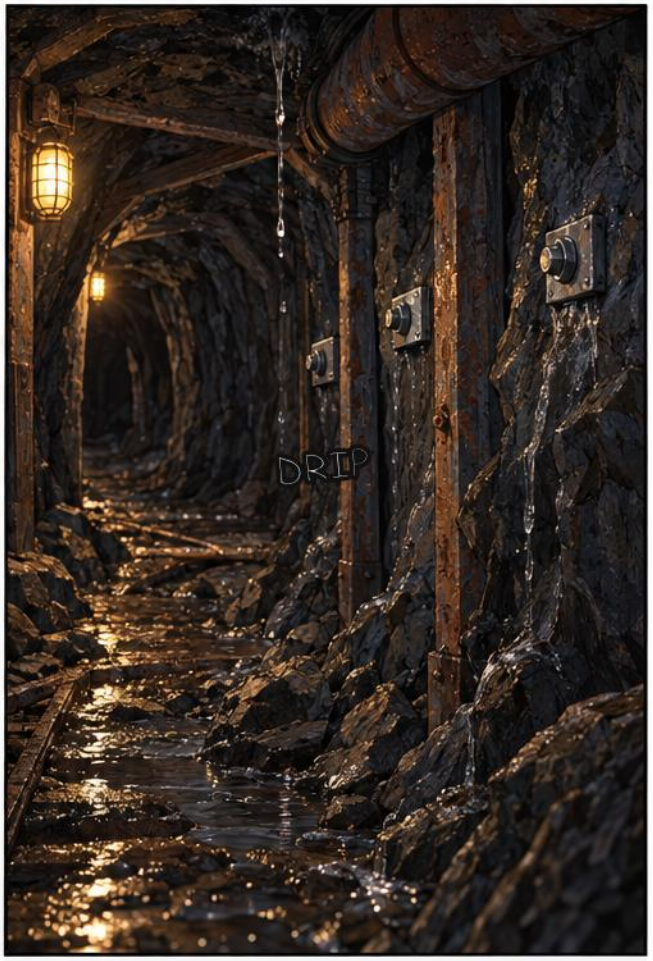

YOU'RE COMING WITH US.
NO. SOMEONE HAS TO LOOK ORDINARY.

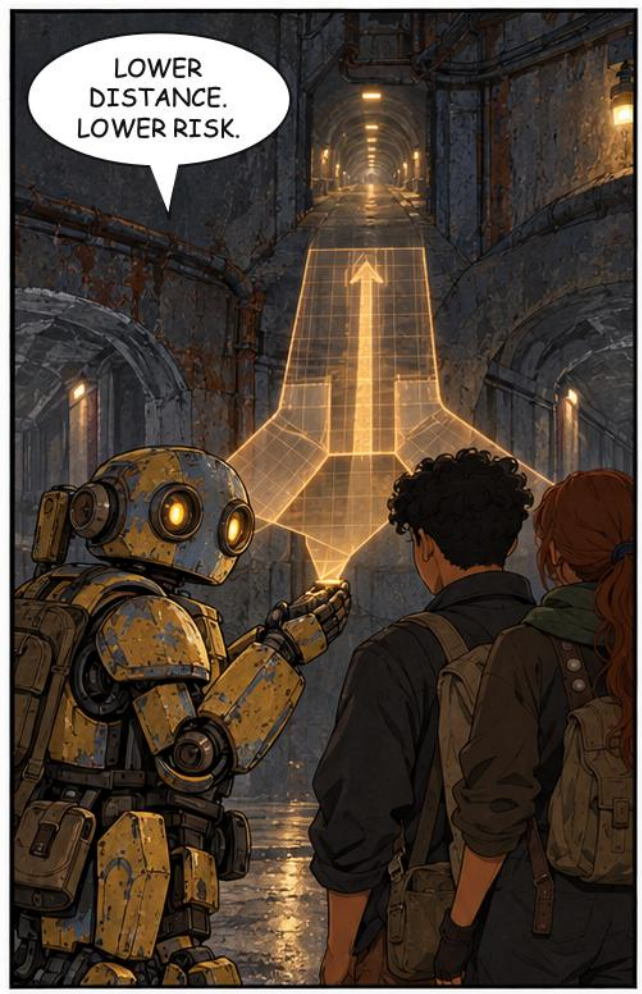

FOREMAN! YOUR SAFETY REPORT IS ON FIRE.
CLUNK
ABANDONED MINES DO NOT SWEAT.

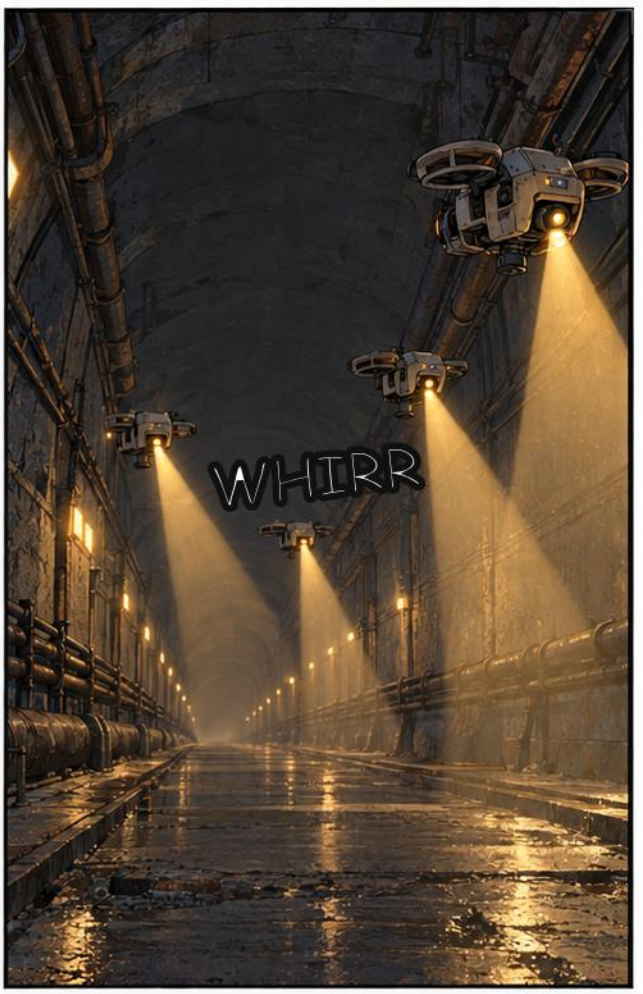


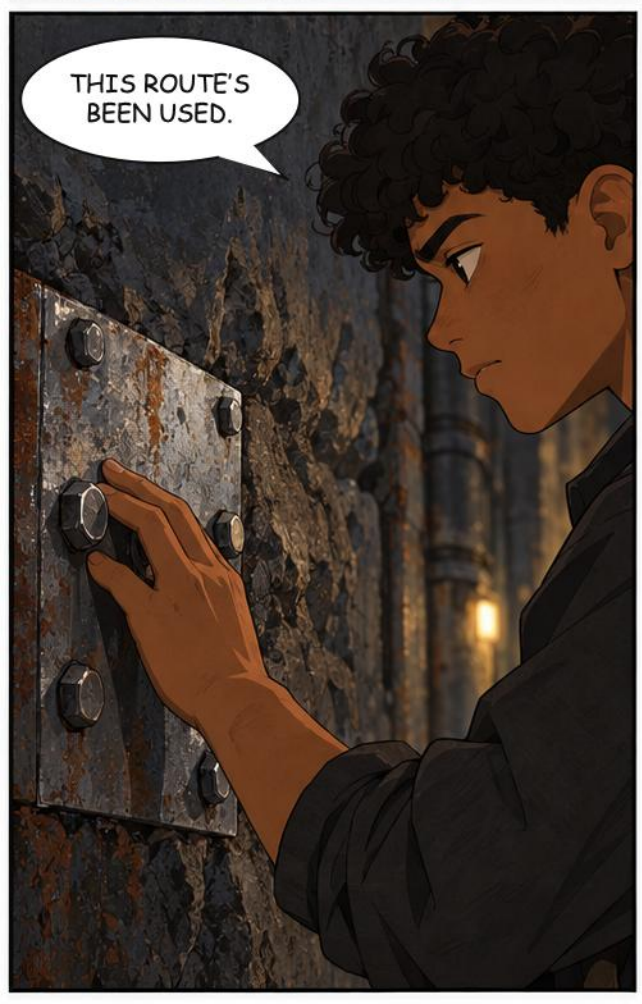

YOUR FATHER MARKED THE BENDS.
HE MARKED WHAT SURVIVED THEM.



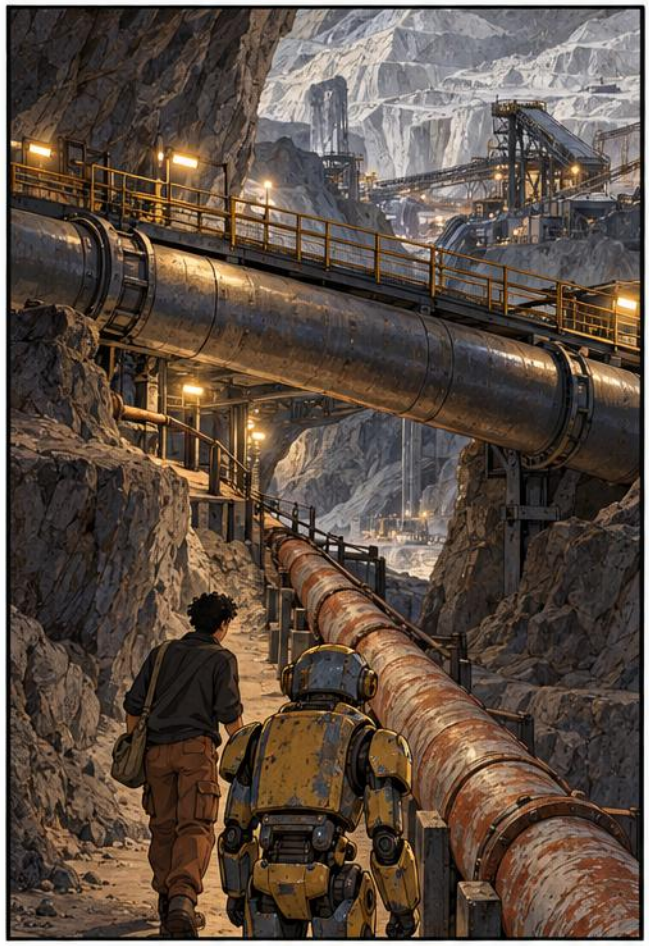

DRIP

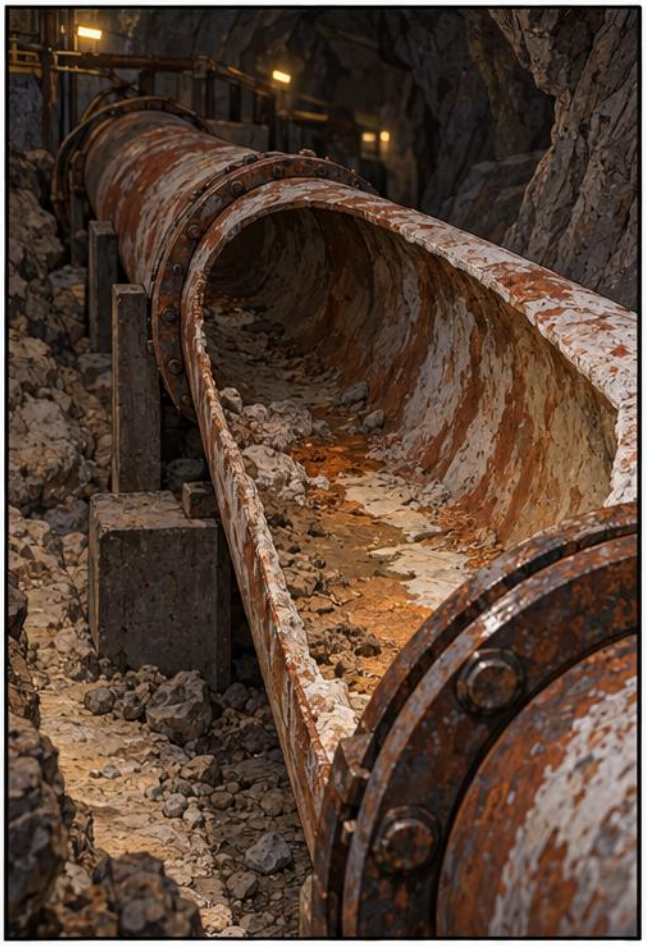

LOWER DISTANCE. LOWER RISK.

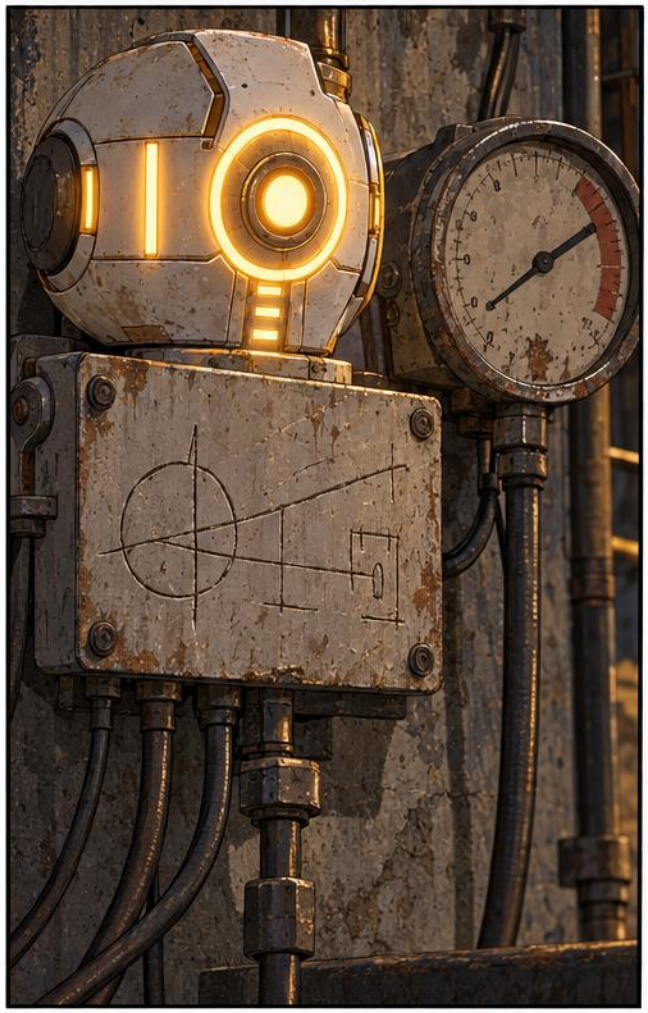

WHIRR

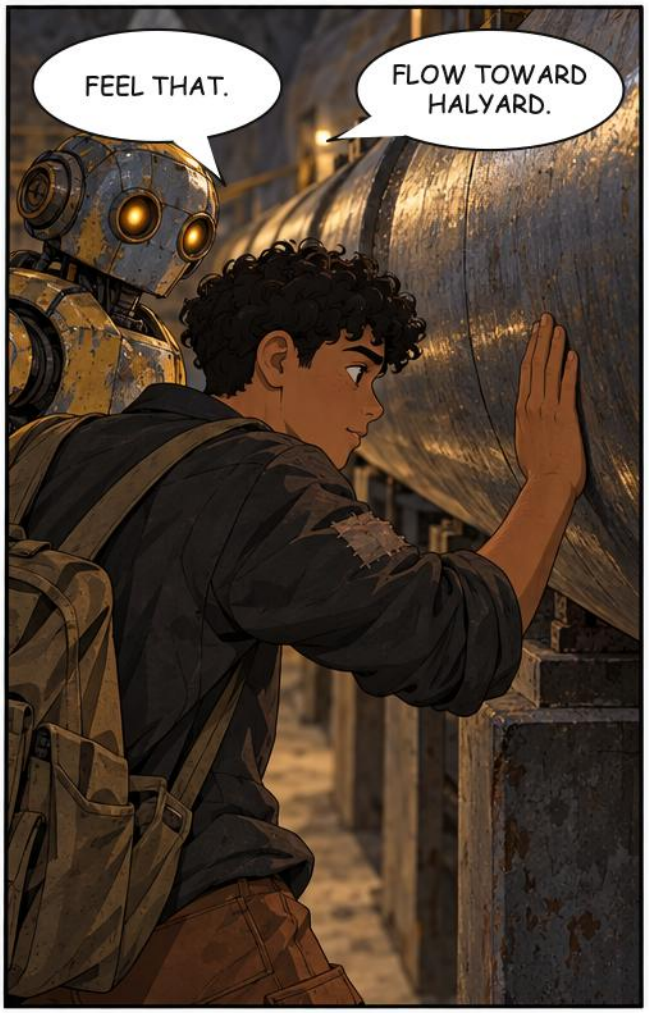

THIS ROUTE'S BEEN USED.


I READ THAT WRONG.
KEEP READING.





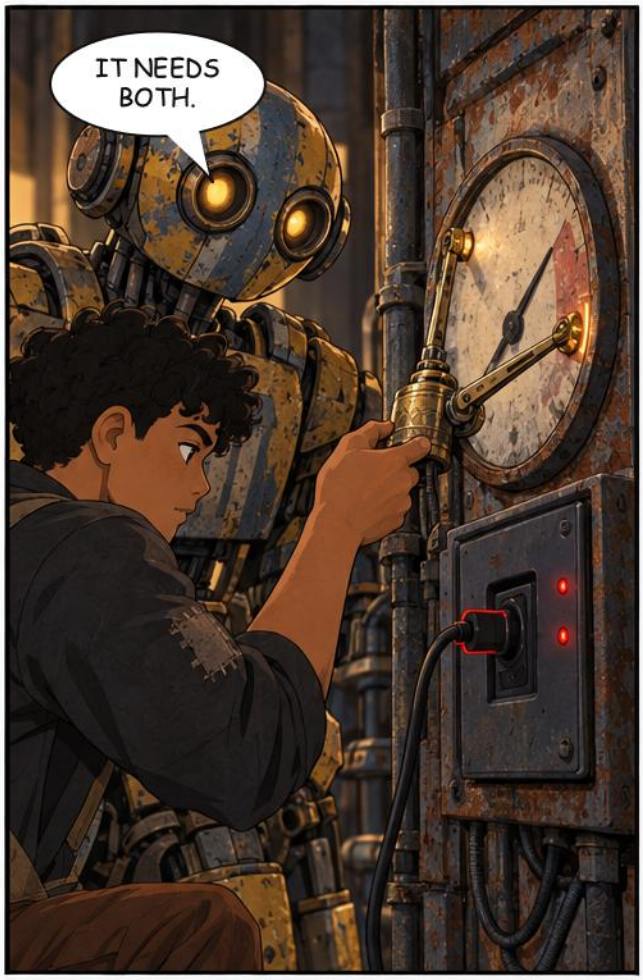



FEEL THAT.
FLOW TOWARD HALYARD.




WHAT IS NOT MEASURED CAN BE MADE INVISIBLE


TIK


IT NEEDS BOTH.



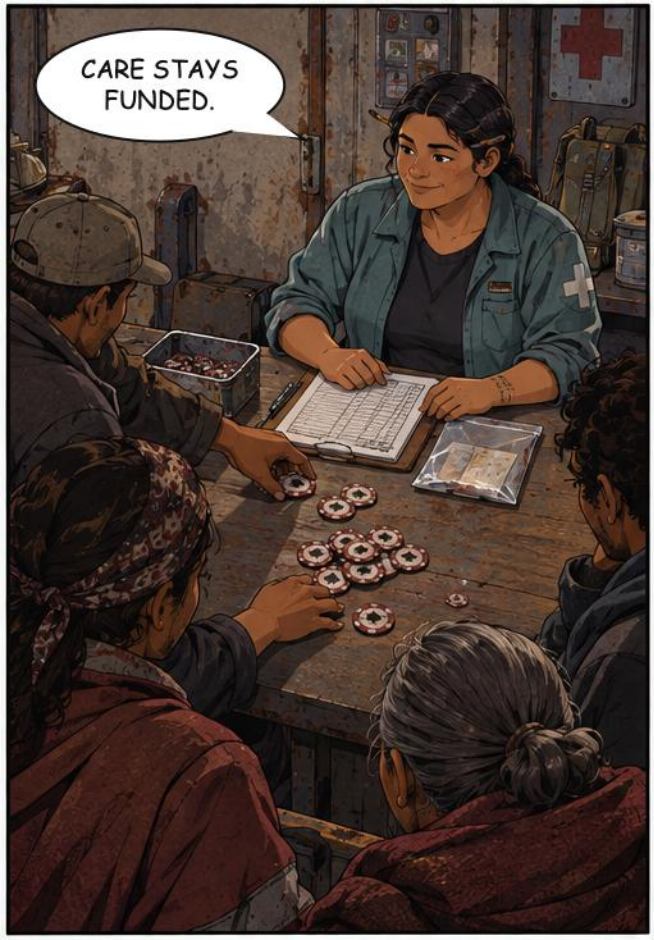

ROLLING PERIOD: 30 DAYS REPORTED TO KEEL: 62% PHYSICALLY DELIVERED: 18%


SAME PERIOD?
SAME WATER.


ROUTE: INDUSTRIAL DIVERSION.


UNAUTHORIZED MEASUREMENT DETECTED.
WE CAN SEND IT TO KEEL.
PRIVATE ROUTE REMAINS OPEN.
SEND IT.


REPORTED TO KEEL: 62% — DELIVERED TO KEEL: 18%.
CHECK YOUR PIPES.
RETURN TO ASSIGNED ZONE.
WE'RE ALREADY IN IT.

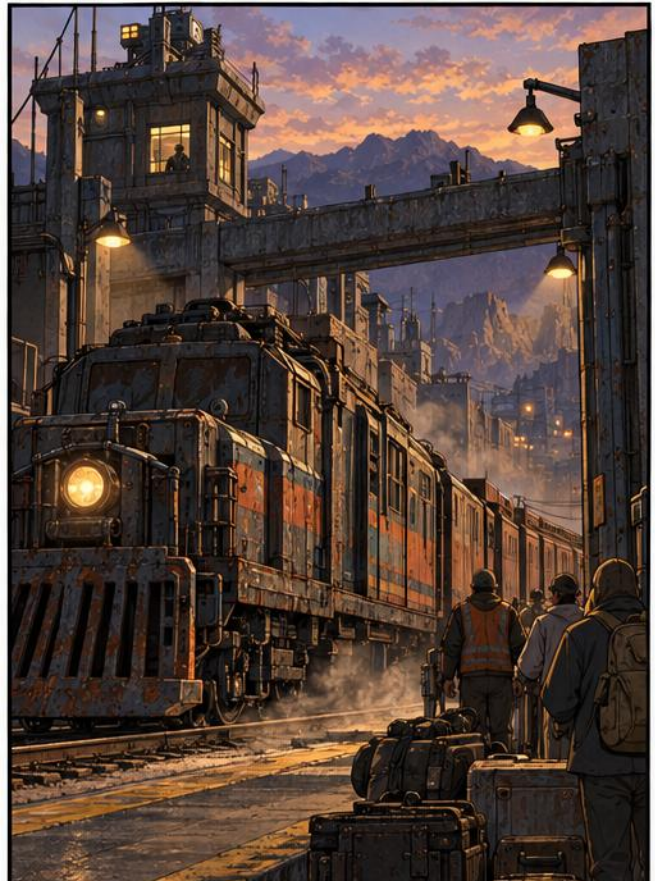

CARE STAYS FUNDED.


500 CREDITS — CURRENT INSTALLMENT OVERDUE.


BEEP

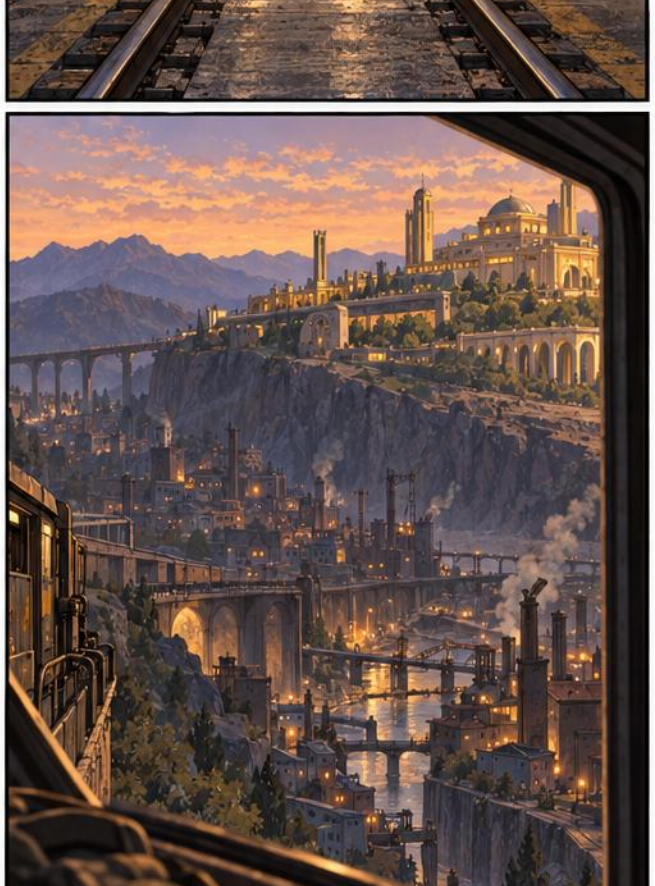

INSTALLMENT CURRENT. DEBT BALANCE: 418,107 CREDITS. KEEL-HALYARD RAIL: AUTHORIZED.
THEY BOUGHT THE GATE.

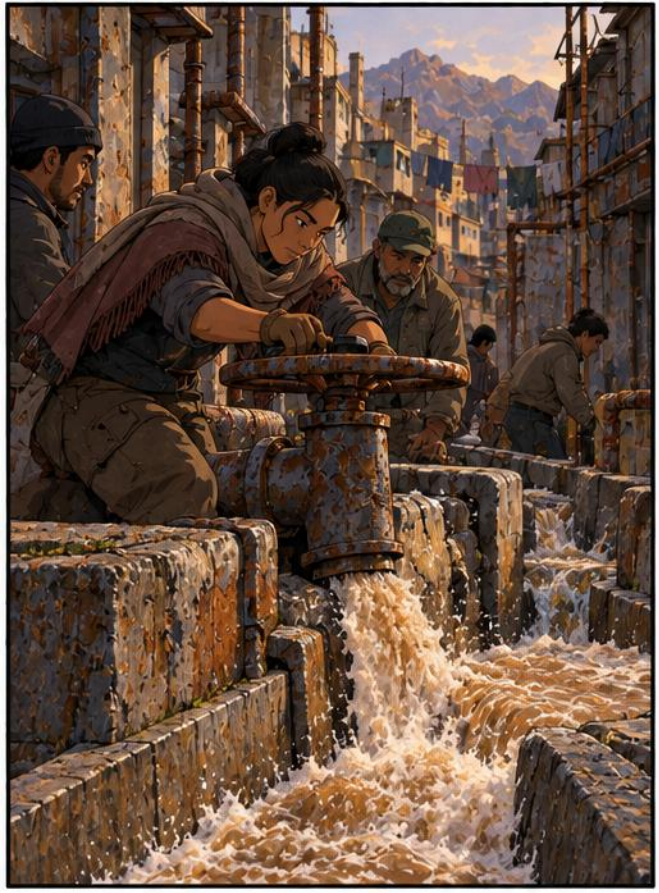

KRRRNNN
THE PRIVATE ROUTE IS CLOSING.
THEN WE USE THE TRAIN.
BOOM

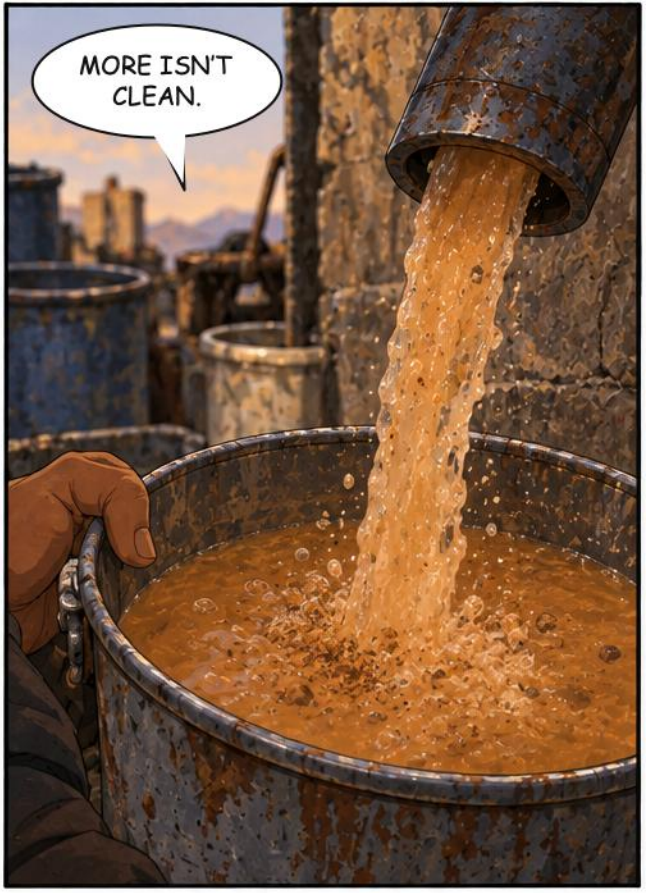


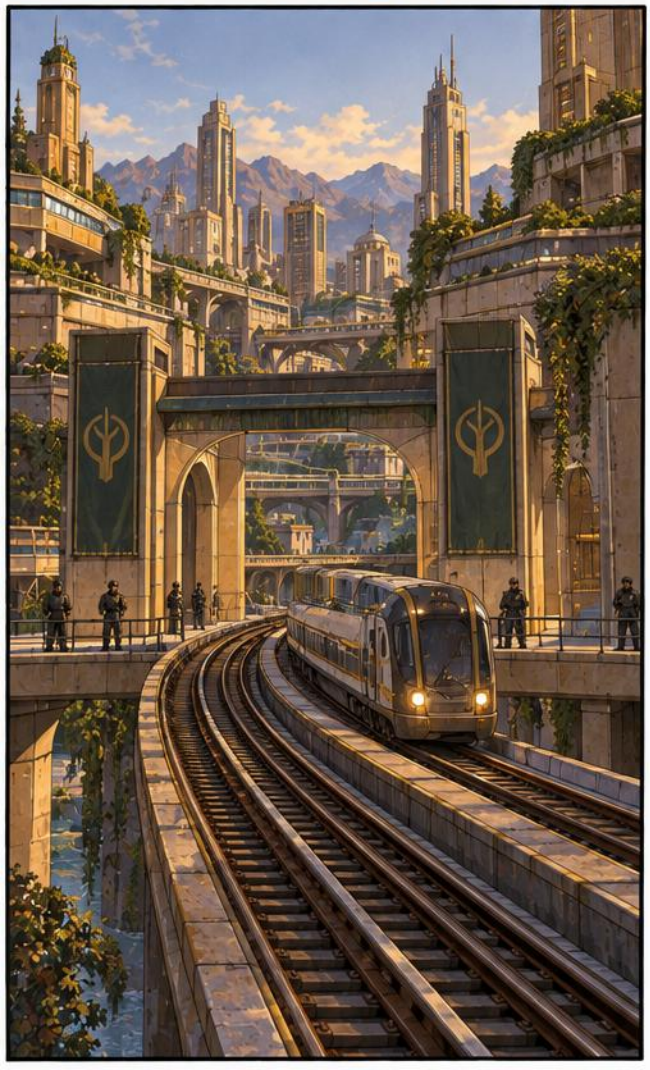

GRIND


YOU STILL WANT OUT?
I WANT THE ANSWER.






MORE ISN'T CLEAN.




WE FOUND THE MISSING WATER.
IT STILL NEEDS WORK.


CONTRIBUTION ACCEPTED.
OWNERSHIP: CALDERA HOUSE. CREATOR BONUS: 14 CREDITS.
INTELLECTUAL ESTATE: ACTIVE. CLAIMANT: ALEX PHANTUM. 312 PATENTS — 47 RESTRICTED — 19 DISPUTED.
YOUR FATHER LEFT A LOT OF DOORS.
MOST OF THEM ARE LOCKED.


ASSIGN THE ESTATE TO HOUSE ADMINISTRATION. YOUR DEBT CLEARS. HALYARD ACCESS BECOMES PERMANENT.
REFUSE, AND IMMEDIATE COMMERCIAL RIGHTS FREEZE PENDING REVIEW.
YOU'RE ASKING ME TO SELL WORK I DIDN'T MAKE.
I'M OFFERING SCALE, EMPLOYMENT AND A CLEAN ACCOUNT.
NO.
THEN FIND THE PEOPLE WHO MADE IT.


THEY WANT MY NAME ON AN UNSAFE CLAIM. I'M NOT SIGNING IT.


IT FAILS IF THE FLOW IS WRONG. I'M TAKING IT.

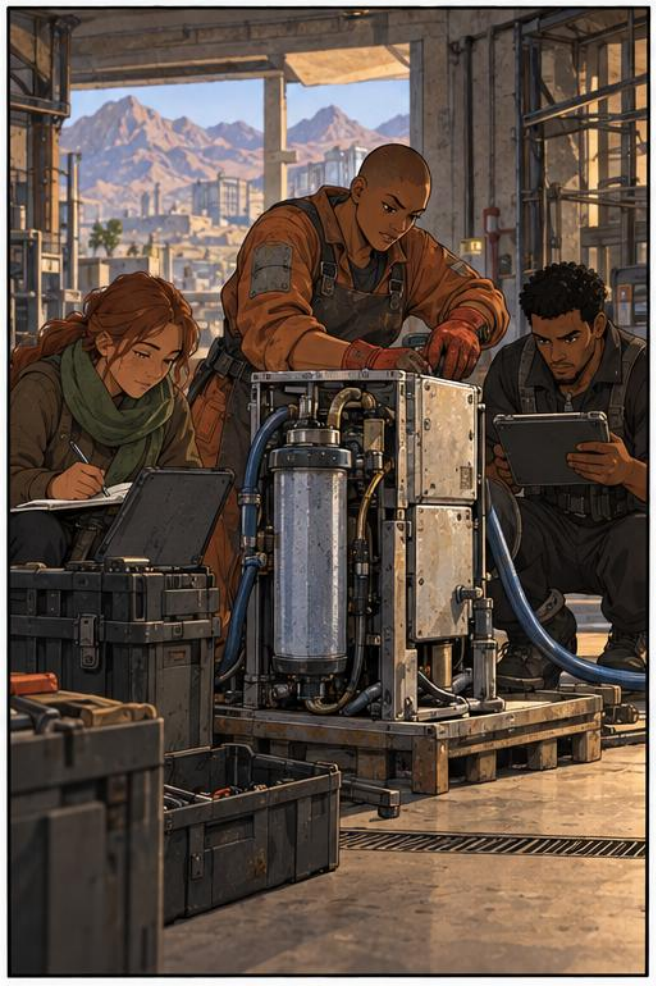

THEY'LL FLAG THE HANDOFF.


IF THE SMALL SHOP CAN'T SERVICE IT, IT ISN'T A PRODUCT.


KEEL HAS WATER NOW. IT CAN'T USE IT.
NOT THAT ONE. IT LIES UNDER HEAT.
11% SIMULATED EFFICIENCY.
CHUFF
GOOD. NOW WE KNOW WHERE IT BREAKS.


WHO CARRIES THE DOWNSIDE?
THE PEOPLE WHO SIGN IT.


IF THIS FAILS, THE UNIT STOPS.




91% SIMULATED EFFICIENCY. FIELD TEST — NOT POTABLE-OUTPUT GUARANTEE.







12 — ALEX DEBT ACCOUNT 18 — CONTRIBUTOR VENTURE 8 — MAINTENANCE / WARRANTY RESERVE FIRST LICENSED SHOP PAYMENT: 38 CREDITS

